Before you begin

Your habit: my story and my diary

Two parts to work on before your cohort begins: your story, and a daily diary. Print these pages, or copy the questions into a notebook that you keep for the whole programme. Write as much or as little as you like. Nothing needs to be shared.

Part 1: My story

1. When did this habit first start? What was happening in your life at the time?

2. Why did it start? What did it give you back then?

3. How has it changed over the years? Think of times it was stronger, weaker, or stopped.

4. What have you tried before, and what did you learn from it?

5. What does it give you now? And what does it cost you?

6. What has brought you to this group, now?

7. Who are you becoming? Describe that person in a few sentences.

Part 2: My diary

Keep this diary every day until the cohort begins, and keep going as you go through the programme. You don't need to change anything yet: just notice.

Day 1 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

8. What did I notice about my habit today?

9. What made it easier? What made it harder?

10. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

11. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Day 2 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

12. What did I notice about my habit today?

13. What made it easier? What made it harder?

14. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

15. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Day 3 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

16. What did I notice about my habit today?

17. What made it easier? What made it harder?

18. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

19. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Day 4 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

20. What did I notice about my habit today?

21. What made it easier? What made it harder?

22. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

23. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Day 5 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

24. What did I notice about my habit today?

25. What made it easier? What made it harder?

26. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

27. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Day 6 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

28. What did I notice about my habit today?

29. What made it easier? What made it harder?

30. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

31. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Day 7 Date: _____

Time	What happened	Where	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt

32. What did I notice about my habit today?

33. What made it easier? What made it harder?

34. Were there patterns: times of day, places, people, moods?

35. What emotions sat underneath it today?

Need more days? Print the diary pages again, or carry on in your notebook.